



affecting the rate of scoring.

Another example of the conditions defining the scoring rate is the year 2016. The T20 World Cup was held in India for the first time that year, showing a spike in strike rates due to the flat pitches on offer.

Graph 2 (on page 23) indicates the strike rates of Indian batters across T20 World Cups.

The inaugural edition of the World Cup in 2007 was an anomaly, with the team mainly comprising younger players who were still adjusting to the new format.

The following five World Cups saw a drop in strike rates before a change in approach in how India plays T20 cricket resulted in teams attacking a lot more over the last two editions.

When comparing the individual strike rates of batters who have scored the most runs in T20 World Cups with their corresponding numbers in the IPL, we see a similar trajectory (**See Graph 3 on page 24**).

Only the Sri Lankan duo of Mahela Jayawardene and Tillakaratne Dilshan have had better strike rates in T20 World Cups compared to the IPL.

In the case of batters known for their aggressive hitting ability — Chris Gayle, Jos Buttler and AB de Villiers — there is a clear indication that their strike rates drop considerably during

the international cup competition.

So, why is the IPL quicker?

Biggers stakes

For all the pride and prestige carried by the IPL, the World Cup is a far bigger stage with a greater prize at stake. The value is also compounded due to its irregular frequency, which contrasts with the yearly affair that is the IPL.

Also at play at the World Cup stage is a sense of national pride, meaning teams and their batters naturally have a propensity to play it safer.

The best example of this is the variance of India's batting strike rate at T20 World Cups, and a parallel can be drawn from another sport, football. Since the turn of the century, the quadrennial FIFA World Cup — a snappier version, similar to the T20 World Cup — has always been a lower-scoring event than the Premier

League, arguably the most popular football competition in the world.

Graph 4 (on page 25) shows a clear trend in Premier League matches, with many more goals scored in comparison to the quadrennial FIFA World Cup.

While the gap between the two competitions has reduced over time, there remains a sizeable difference in the goals-per-match ratio between the two events.

Therefore, national pride and increased jeopardy in international competitions are major factors defining performances across multiple sporting disciplines.

Length of the tournament

The recently concluded IPL season had 74 matches, with each team playing a minimum of 14 games. The 2024 T20 World Cup has just 55 games, with teams assured of only

A longer tournament like the IPL with a round-robin format allows teams to play a far more aggressive brand of cricket, as the law of averages will eventually come to their rescue.

GRAPH 1: T20 WC Strike Rate and IPL Strike Rate

